

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR SUB-INSPECTOR OF STATISTICS
UNDER PLANNING & PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(JANUARY-2026)

PAPER-I
(GENERAL ENGLISH)

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 150

SECTION - A (Conventional Type) (50 Marks)

*This section should be answered only on the **Answer Sheet** provided.*

Marks for each question is indicated against it.

Attempt all questions.

1. Write an essay on any one of the following topics: (20)

- (i) Creating a prosperous, just and harmonious India.
- (ii) Instilling ethical values in youth: Forging virtuous citizens through moral education
- (iii) Investment in knowledge pays the best interest

2. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

Regular exercise provides a wide array of benefits for both physical and mental health, including weight management, disease prevention, and improved mood and cognitive function. Engaging in physical activity strengthens muscles and bones, boosts energy levels, and improves sleep patterns. Furthermore, exercise is a crucial tool for reducing stress, anxiety, and the risk of chronic diseases, ultimately leading to a higher quality of life and a longer life expectancy.

In the short term, exercise offers immediate improvements to physical and mental well-being. It releases endorphins, which boost mood and act as a natural stress reliever, and can help improve sleep quality. The physical act of moving the body also increases energy levels and can help manage appetite. For those who feel sluggish, a workout can actually be the catalyst for feeling more energized throughout the day.

Over the long term, consistent exercise builds a stronger, more resilient body. Activities like weightlifting and running strengthen bones and muscles, which can prevent osteoporosis and reduce the risk of falls later in life. Exercise also strengthens the cardiovascular system, lowers blood pressure, and improves blood circulation, all of which reduce the risk of developing heart disease, stroke, type 2 diabetes, and certain cancers.

Beyond physical fitness, regular exercise is a powerful tool for mental health. It improves brain function, enhances cognitive abilities, and can even lower the risk of developing dementia. Exercise provides a sense of accomplishment and pride, which helps build self-esteem and emotional balance. It also creates opportunities for social interaction through group activities like sports teams or exercise classes, which can combat loneliness and foster a sense of community.

- (a) What induces a longer life expectancy and in what way? (2)
- (b) How does exercise change individual's emotional state at a particular time? (2)

- (c) What are the longer-term benefits of regular exercise for human's heart? (2)
- (d) According to this passage, how is a more resilient body achieved? (2)
- (e) Find the synonym of the words given below from the passage. (1+1=2)
 - (i) Essential
 - (ii) Memory loss

3. Write a precis of the passage given below: (20)

The rise of social media has fundamentally changed how we interact, communicate, and consume information. Platforms like Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram have become dominant forces in our daily lives, offering new avenues for connection but also presenting new challenges. On the positive side, these platforms allow for instant communication across vast distances, enabling people to maintain relationships, form communities around shared interests, and mobilize for social and political causes. They provide a space for creative expression, business promotion, and the dissemination of news, often at a faster rate than traditional media.

However, the negative aspects are significant. The constant bombardment of curated and often unrealistic portrayals of life can lead to feelings of inadequacy and a decline in mental well-being. The spread of misinformation and "fake news" is a major concern, as algorithms can amplify sensational or false content, making it difficult for users to distinguish between truth and falsehood. Furthermore, the addictive nature of social media, designed to maximize user engagement through likes, shares, and notifications, can lead to reduced productivity and a decline in face-to-face social skills. Privacy concerns are also paramount, as users often share vast amounts of personal data, which can be exploited by companies for targeted advertising or other purposes. In conclusion, while social media offers unprecedented opportunities for connection and information sharing, its pervasive influence comes with significant risks to mental health, social cohesion, and individual privacy, necessitating a more critical and balanced approach to its use.

SECTION - B (Multiple Choice questions) (100 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 2 each. Attempt all questions.

*This section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 10) : Fill in the blanks with the correct form of verbs given in the brackets.

- 1. I'm sorry I can't hear what you are saying because everybody _____ (talk) so loudly.
 - (a) talks
 - (b) is talking
 - (c) has talked
 - (d) was talking
- 2. When Damien called last night, I _____ (watch) the Titanic Movie.
 - (a) watched
 - (b) am watching
 - (c) has been watching
 - (d) was watching
- 3. By this time next year, you _____ (complete) your studies and found a job.
 - (a) will be completing
 - (b) will have completed
 - (c) will complete
 - (d) will have been completing
- 4. Last week, I ran into an old friend of mine. We _____ (see, not) each other in years and both of us had changed a great deal.
 - (a) have not seen
 - (b) did not see
 - (c) had not seen
 - (d) has not seen

5. Rama was reading a novel while his wife _____ (sleep).
(a) sleeps (b) slept
(c) has been sleeping (d) was sleeping
6. By the end of this year, she _____ (work) in this department for twenty-five years.
(a) has worked (b) had worked
(c) will have been working (d) is working
7. When I reached the station, the train _____ (leave).
(a) already left (b) has already left
(c) had already left (d) was already left
8. He said that by the time we arrived, they _____ (finish) everything.
(a) will finish (b) would finish
(c) would have finished (d) will have finished
9. By next December, he _____ (serve) as the principal for fifteen years.
(a) will serve (b) will be serving
(c) will have served (d) will have been serving
10. I didn't recognize her at first because she _____ (change) so much.
(a) changed (b) had changed
(c) was changing (d) has changed

Direction (Question Nos. 11 - 20) : Insert correct prepositions to complete the sentences given below:

11. The man was acquitted _____ all charges.
(a) of (b) on
(c) in (d) at
12. He hinted _____ some loss of treasure.
(a) of (b) in
(c) for (d) at
13. He is a great orator _____ my surprise.
(a) beyond (b) upon
(c) to (d) above
14. Thanga is well known in Mizoram _____ the books he has already written.
(a) by (b) for
(c) on (d) about
15. He took action pursuant _____ the recommendation of the Board.
(a) to (b) of
(c) with (d) on
16. Mawia is indifferent _____ any request made by his students just yesterday.
(a) about (b) on
(c) at (d) to
17. Liani is good _____ painting and playing Chess.
(a) in (b) on
(c) at (d) for
18. Sanga is conversant _____ modern history.
(a) of (b) at
(c) on (d) with

19. She is proficient _____ three languages
(a) on (b) of
(c) with (d) in
20. The matter falls _____ the jurisdiction of the Supreme court.
(a) on (b) under
(c) over (d) in

Direction (Question Nos. 21 - 30) : Change each of the following sentences as directed in the brackets.

21. He climbed up the tree and plucked some mangoes. (Change to a Simple sentence)
(a) He climbed up the tree and plucked some mangoes.
(b) Climbing up the tree, he plucks some mangoes.
(c) He climbed up the tree so he plucked some mangoes.
(d) Climbing up the tree, he plucked some mangoes.
22. Does the police officer catch the thief? (Change the Voice)
(a) Is the thief caught by the police officer?
(b) Had the thief been caught by the police officer?
(c) Has the thief been caught by the police officer?
(d) Is the thief been caught by the police officer?
23. He hopes to win a prize. (Change the voice)
(a) It is hoped that he will win a prize. (b) A prize is to be won by him.
(c) He hopes that he wins the prize. (d) It is hoped to win a prize.
24. Let the poor not be teased. (Change the voice)
(a) Let people not teased the poor. (b) Do not tease the poor.
(c) Let the poor not be teased by people. (d) Do not tease the poor people.
25. Mandy said, "John wrote the letter." (Change the speech)
(a) Mandy said that John had written the letter.
(b) Mandy told that John was writing the letter.
(c) Mandy said that John has written the letter.
(d) Mandy says that John writes the letter.
26. I told Mala that I would see her the following day. (Change the Speech)
(a) I said to Mala, "I will see you the following day."
(b) I said to Mala, "I will see you tomorrow."
(c) I told Mala, "I will see you tomorrow."
(d) I said to Mala, "I would see you tomorrow."
27. He was too ill to attend school yesterday. (Change to Negative)
(a) He was so ill that he could not attend school yesterday.
(b) He was not too ill to attend school yesterday.
(c) He was too ill to not attend school yesterday.
(d) He was not so ill to attend school yesterday.
28. How sweetly she sings! (Change to Assertive)
(a) She sang a song sweetly. (b) Oh! How sweetly her song is!
(c) She sings very sweetly. (d) She sings a sweet song.

29. I can never forget your kindness. (Change to Interrogative)
(a) Can I never forget your kindness? (b) Can I ever forget your kindness?
(c) Can I never forget your kindness. (d) Can I ever forget your kindness.
30. Would that I were a king! (Change to Assertive)
(a) I wish I were a king. (b) I would be a king.
(c) Would I be a king? (d) I wish I would be a king!

Direction (Question Nos. 31 - 40) : Each of the following sentences has a word underlined. Find which part of speech the underlined word belong to.

31. However tired he was, he finished the task.
(a) Noun (b) Verb
(c) Adverb (d) Adjective
32. The righteous always emerge victorious.
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Plural Noun (d) Singular Noun
33. Sawmi goes to school every day.
(a) Adverb (b) Pronoun
(c) Determiner (d) Preposition
34. He seems very tired after the long journey
(a) Adverb (b) Determiner
(c) Adjective (d) Verb
35. Her happiness was obvious.
(a) Abstract noun (b) Adverb
(c) Adjective (d) Preposition
36. The Grand Canyon is a natural wonder.
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Preposition (d) Noun
37. Can you answer this question?
(a) Preposition (b) Noun
(c) Pronoun (d) Adverb
38. We are pleased to come here.
(a) Adjective (b) Pronoun
(c) Verb (d) Noun
39. Still water runs deep.
(a) Noun (b) Adjective
(c) Adverb (d) Preposition
40. Do you prefer tea or coffee?
(a) Conjunction (b) Interjection
(c) Adverb (d) Verb

Direction (Question Nos. 41 - 50) : Choose the correct meaning of the words given below from the options provided.

41. A bone of contention
(a) A subject of disagreement (b) A dog's favourite bone
(c) A subject of contentment (d) A good thought or idea
42. To pay through the nose
(a) To pay less amount of money.
(b) To pay far more money than something is worth.
(c) To pay for one's own actions.
(d) To pay off a debt.
43. To see eye to eye with
(a) To have the same opinion with someone about something.
(b) To be able to see clearly
(c) To look intensely, curiously or carefully
(d) To remain calm and show no fear
44. Apprise
(a) To examine and form an opinion about something
(b) To inform about something
(c) To approve formally
(d) To criticize harshly
45. Officiate
(a) To perform a ceremony, function or duty
(b) To argue a case in a law court
(c) To delay or postpone an important matter
(d) To decorate or make something look attractive
46. Embargo
(a) A legal prohibition on commerce
(b) A formal agreement between two nations to increase free trade
(c) An official permission granted to export special goods
(d) A minor penalty given to government officials
47. Expunge
(a) To destroy completely (b) To praise enthusiastically
(c) To remove completely (d) To recognise enthusiastically
48. Articulate
(a) Having extensive knowledge
(b) Skilled in practical task rather than theoretical knowledge
(c) Fond of artistic activities
(d) Able to express oneself effectively and clearly
49. A dime a dozen
(a) Expensive (b) Valuable and rare
(c) Common and Cheap (d) Unique
50. To pick holes
(a) To quarrel with someone (b) To cut holes in something
(c) To criticise someone (d) To applaud someone